

Mariana Bacelo Soares

SENIOR SERVICE DESIGNER | SERVICE STRATEGY & DIGITAL TRANSFORMATION

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Service Designer with 8 years of experience across service design, product design and UX, focused on service strategy, discovery and digital transformation. Skilled at understanding complex business ecosystems, translating fragmented legacy processes into coherent digital service experiences and connecting user research to strategic decisions. International consulting experience spanning Portuguese public services, UK pharmaceutical R&D, industrial operations and financial services.

CORE SKILLS

Service Design; Service Strategy; Product Discovery; User Research; Qualitative and Quantitative Research; Stakeholder Management; Workshop Facilitation; Journey Mapping; Business Process Mapping; Legacy System Modernisation; Research Synthesis; UX Strategy; Digital Transformation; Experience Measurement.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Service Design Consultant

AstraZeneca | Project-Based Independent Contractor

United Kingdom | Pharmaceutical R&D | May 2026 – Present

- Lead discovery of complex R&D workflows, investigating legacy Excel-based processes, dispersed data sources and interdependencies between business teams.
- Translate operational challenges and business requirements into end-to-end service journeys and usable digital experiences supporting demand intake, prioritisation, resource allocation and operational oversight.
- Collaborate with UK-based and international business, design and technical stakeholders to align user needs, operational constraints and service direction.

Service Design Consultant

Instituto de Informática, I.P. — Portuguese Social Security

Portugal | Public Administration | Independent Contractor | May 2025 – Present

- Plan and conduct user research across Portuguese Social Security digital services, including 10+ research activities involving interviews, focus groups, workshops and direct engagement with citizens and employees.
- Synthesize qualitative findings, survey responses and behavioural analytics (SAS Customer Intelligence 360) into insights, opportunities and strategic recommendations for digital service improvement.
- Support service prioritisation and experience measurement by connecting research evidence with user needs and organisational goals.

Customer Experience Strategist

Ilegra

Industrial and Financial Services Consulting | Jan 2023 – May 2025

- Contributed across the product lifecycle, from discovery and business analysis through service and product strategy, cross-functional solution development, usability research and experience measurement.
- Worked on 12+ industrial projects associated with over US\$30M in estimated potential gains; project outcomes included an NPS increase from 40 to 78.2 and a product experience score of 38/44.

Senior Product Designer

Jul 2021 – Jan 2023

- Led design-system standards and UX writing guidelines across four financial software modules; supported discovery, user validation and usability improvements for accounting and tax-reporting workflows.

Service Designer

Reserva

Retail and E-commerce | Feb 2021 – Jul 2021

- Mapped cross-channel customer journeys during retail-to-digital transformation; combined user research, analytics and UX improvements and contributed to the Oracle-to-VTEX CMS migration and mobile app development.

Product Designer

Act Digital

Financial Services | Mar 2020 – Feb 2021

- Conducted user research and designed digital experiences for Prudential Brazil insurance services and the BTG Pactual investor portal.

UX/UI Designer & Researcher

iFriend

Travel | Apr 2019 – Mar 2020

- Created an application design system and analysed product behaviour using Hotjar to identify UX improvement opportunities with product and marketing teams.

UX/UI Designer

ByteMe

Venture Builder | Oct 2018 – Apr 2019

- Designed websites and digital products alongside business stakeholders and developers, from discovery and interface design through product launch.

EDUCATION

University of Coimbra – Master in Marketing

2022 – 2024 | Final grade: 19/20. Thesis on competitiveness and differentiation strategies in integrated supply chains.

University Center IBMR – Technology Degree in Graphic Design

2019 – 2021 | Specialisation: User Interface Design and Mobile User Experience.

Fluminense Federal University (UFF) – Bachelor in Industrial Design

2018 – 2021 | Focus: Accessibility and ergonomics for people with intellectual disabilities.

TOOLS & TECHNOLOGIES

Research and analytics: SAS Customer Intelligence 360 (SAS CI 360), Power BI, Excel, Google Analytics, Hotjar, Pendo, NPS, CSAT, A/B Testing.

Design and delivery: Figma, Power Apps, SQL, Jira, Azure DevOps.

LANGUAGES

Portuguese (Native) | English (C1) | French (B1)